

Question:

Which of the following factors is associated with a decreased risk of Alzheimer's?

Answer Choices:

- A. Being African or Hispanic American
- B. A lower level of education
- C. Living in a city
- D. Being married
- E. Having a family history of Alzheimer's
- F. High intake of saturated fats
- G. Older age
- H. Eating fish
- I. Being a smoker
- J. Drinking alcohol regularly

Reasoning + Answer:

<tool_call> Reasoning process here :

To identify which factor is associated with a decreased risk of Alzheimer's , we evaluate each option based on established medical and epidemiological research .

A . Being African or Hispanic American â Studies show that individuals from certain racial and ethnic groups , including African and Hispanic Americans , may have higher risks of Alzheimer's due to socioeconomic , environmental , and biological factors . So , this is not protective .

B . A lower level of education â Lower educational attainment is associated with increased risk of Alzheimer's , likely due to reduced cognitive reserve . So , this increases risk , not decreases .

C . Living in a city â Urban living may have mixed effects , but there's no strong evidence that it directly reduces Alzheimer's risk ; in fact , urban areas may have higher stress or pollution risks . No clear protective association .

D . Being married â Several studies show that being married is associated with a lower risk of dementia , including Alzheimer's . Social engagement , emotional support , and stability may play protective roles . This is a well-documented protective factor .

E . Having a family history of Alzheimer's â This is a genetic risk factor ; it increases risk , not decreases it .

F . High intake of saturated fats â Associated with increased risk of cardiovascular disease and neurodegeneration ; increases Alzheimer's risk .

G . Older age â Age is the greatest known risk factor for Alzheimer's ; risk increases with age .

H . Eating fish â Fish , especially fatty fish like salmon , contain omega - 3 fatty acids (DHA) , which are linked to better brain health and a reduced risk of dementia . This is supported by evidence , as omega - 3 s may support neuro protection .

I . Being a smoker â Smoking increases Alzheimer's risk due to vascular and inflammatory damage .

J . Drinking alcohol regularly â Excessive alcohol intake increases risk ; moderate intake may have mixed effects , but regular drinking (especially heavy) increases risk .

So , the factors associated with decreased risk are :

- D . Being married
- H . Eating fish

Now , the question asks : Which of the following factors is associated with a decreased risk ?

Both D and H are protective . But among the options , only one is to be selected (assuming single choice) , and both are valid . However , " eating fish " is often linked more directly to brain health via diet and nutrition , while being married is a social factor .

Still , being married is widely cited in studies (e.g. , the Harvard Study of Adult Development) as protecting against cognitive decline .

But let's confirm which one is best supported and most clearly associated with reduced risk .

Recent meta - analyses and reviews point to diet (particularly omega - 3 s from fish) and social engagement (marital status) as independent protective factors .

However , â eating fish â is a specific dietary behavior and appears in multiple studies as beneficial . But â being married â is also consistently protective .

But the answer options are individual , and we are to pick one correct one .

Looking back : among all , the strongest evidence shows that social engagement and being married is associated with lower dementia risk , and also , fish consumption is protective . But which one is the most directly and consistently linked ?

Still , both D and H are valid .

But the question says â which of the following factors â singular â and lists them as options .

But if only one is correct , which one ?

Check the options : H . Eating fish is supported by multiple studies (e.g. , Mediterranean diet , omega - 3 s) . D . Being married is supported by longitudinal studies .

However , in cognitive neuroscience and public health , both are valid , but â eating fish â may be more directly tied to neuro protection via diet , whereas marital status is more about social and psychological support .

But in standard Alzheimer â risk assessments , multiple studies show marital status as protective (e.g. , the link between social connection and cognitive health) .

Still , note that the most consistent and independently associated protective factor that is clearly recognized in public health literature is ** social engagement ** â and being married is a component of that .

But according to large - scale studies